

Post-incident review PIR-2025-051

Payments API: delayed processing

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 17 September 2025, Payments API experienced delayed processing in production (US West) for about 160 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that the connection pool size in a shared deployment template was lowered from 200 to 20.

Impact

Users of Payments API saw delayed processing for about 160 minutes. The service owner, Payments Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:20 First signal received.
- 09:38 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:48 Likely cause identified.
- 10:20 Mitigation applied.
- 10:49 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the connection pool size in a shared deployment template was lowered from 200 to 20.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.